

Get a Foundation to
Require All T/M programs & forms to
Use OHATS — Have Finality fees
How many asking for OHATS?

O H A T S

A Way for Community Organizations to Systematically Track and Share Their History and Accomplishments

Procedures for Development and Application

Co-Sponsored by the Tutor/Mentor Connection of Cabrini Connections and Akouo

For additional information or questions please visit
http://www.tutormentorexchange.net/OHATS/Intro_OHATS.htm OR
email support@tutormentorexchange.net.

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1. Brief Background and Purpose of OHATS

OHATS is a web-based, database system that organizations working to improve their community use OHATS to track, understand, sustain, and improve their work. The idea behind OHATS is simple and proven throughout history: you can change what you can measure. Ideally, this change is intended to be an improvement toward a valued end. If this idea is applied to the work of community change, then community organizations that measure how they change their community conditions to influence their target goal are likely to be more influential than those that do not. If community groups track information important to their success (such as lessons, challenges, key events, accomplishments, and contributions) then they can learn from it and be more successful.

OHATS was established in 2000 through a small community grant to Cabrini Connections, a Chicago-area support organization for tutor/mentor programs, and Akouo, a community research and support group. Although any organization can use OHATS, the use of OHATS through the Tutor/Mentor Exchange is intended for organizations that provide services or support programs in the area of tutoring, mentoring and school-to-work. If you would like to use OHATS outside of the Tutor/Mentor Exchange, please contact us at support@tutormentorexchange.net.

The principles and methods of OHATS come from research and practice in the fields of community health and development. Similar documentation systems have been used for years to evaluate and support collaborative community initiatives with a mission to improve community-wide health and development outcomes (please contact us for references to this research and publications). Lessons from this research and practical experiences were adopted and applied to develop OHATS, so community organizations can track, share and reflect on their progress and contributions. OHATS addresses a need present in every organization that is trying to improve the welfare of their community, but more acute in networks and collaborations. It allows any organizational stakeholder to document and see what he/she does to achieve the organization's mission, while demonstrating the cumulative impact of actions across stakeholders. As a result, those within and outside the organization can better understand and improve their cumulative and synergistic progress toward their shared objectives.

In its most simple form, OHATS is a simple journaling method that allows one or more staff and stakeholders from an organization to record and share items important to their mission. Its power and utility comes from specific prompts and categories of reporting that are based on the organizations' strategic plan and objectives, and on research on effective documentation systems. These prompts and categorization methods allow you to accurately collect and quickly find information, and to use that information intelligently for critical reflection and evaluation, publicity and media, and facilitating support, as from specific donors and the broader community.

OHATS is on the Internet to make it easier to use by any tutor/mentor organization or program, and to reduce barriers to its use, such as location and time of access, software costs and compatibility across users in different locations, and the need for training in developing and managing databases. Also, by using OHATS through the Internet an organization can save significant supply and staff costs for developing and maintaining such a system on their own. OHATS is created and managed on Microsoft Access 2000 and/or SQL Server 2000 working on Windows 2000/NT 4 with IIS. Our systems are stored and managed using one of the most reliable and highly rated web hosts available, Burlee. More information on the high quality of our web system can be found at http://www.burlee.com/aboutburlee/aboutburlee_datacenter.asp. Depending on the organization's technology resources, OHATS data entry screens also can be created for personal digital assistants using the Palm OS, and permit synchronization of OHATS data entry through the Internet. If your organization is in a situation where Internet access is not feasible or reliable, please contact our OHATS Support Staff to discuss other ways to create and use your own OHATS.

2. How an Organization Can Set Up Its Own OHATS

An organization can set up its own OHATS by following four steps.

Step 1 - Determine the Appropriateness of OHATS for Your Needs. Contact the OHATS Support Staff (support@tutormentorexchange.net) to set up a time for a telephone discussion of your needs and use of OHATS. After you and the OHATS Support Staff agree that OHATS is appropriate for your needs, you can begin the design of your OHATS.

Step 2 - Design and Customize OHATS for Your Needs. OHATS includes five parts that can be customized depending on what is most important to your organization. Each part consists of web screens to input, edit and view information. You select which parts you want to have in your OHATS during a phone conversation with the OHATS Support Staff. *At minimum, an OHATS includes two parts:* Reporter Description/Log In and Documentation of Actions, Events and Contributions.

OHATS Parts:

Reporter Description and Log In - Screens that collect information on each OHATS reporter (e.g., name, role in the organization, contact information to clarify and validate their comments) and establish a user name and password for the reporter.

Documentation of Actions, Events & Contributions - Screens that allow a reporter to document and categorize items important to the mission of the organization in an organized and accurate manner. This includes screens to edit and view different formats of the information.

Documentation of Publicity and Media - Screens that allow a reporter to describe press, media and public communications about the organization and its activities. This includes screens to edit and view different formats of the information.

Documentation of Resources Generated - Screens that allow a reporter to describe resources generated, such as grants, in-kind support or donations, and other resources. This includes screens to edit and view different formats of the information.

Documentation of Service Statistics - Screens that allow a reporter to describe the number of participants and other service information (e.g., costs, results) for existing services or programs that the organization offers. This includes screens to edit and view different formats of the information. This includes screens to edit and view different formats of the information.

The OHATS Support Staff will show you a list of variables that can be included in each part. Then, you decide which variables you want to include in your OHATS. You also may change the wording or naming of some variable so that they match your organizations work. For example, you can have a list of your staff in a drop-down menu, or a list of known funders or supporter shown in your OHATS so that you do not have to repeatedly type their names every time you report something.

The Documentation of Actions, Events & Contributions part is the core of OHATS and offers the greatest customization. This part offers a selection of up to twenty-five different variables. These variables are specifically designed to collect information known to be useful for tracking organizational history and accomplishment, and to match an organization's strategic plan, goals and objectives. You select and customize your selection of these variables depending on how you want to use OHATS (e.g., for simple logging of lessons, events, and contributions, for evaluation of progress over time or across goals, etc.) and the way your organization works (e.g., whether

your organization targets specific populations, such as youth or people with developmental disabilities, or maybe your organization wants to track its contributions by zip code or geographic area). Some examples of these variables and their options are shown in the illustrative forms in the next section of this document.

During the customizations period, OHATS Support Staff will show you the options of the variables available and help you decide which ones will best match the needs of your organization. The customization period will include your selection of methods to view your OHATS information and reports, and methods for receiving your raw OHATS data (e.g., in Microsoft Excel or Access format, or some other data structure). Depending on the degree of customization you require, this period may take between one to two weeks.

Step 3 - Test Your OHATS. After you customize the design of your OHATS, you will have an opportunity to test it and work with the OHATS Support Staff to make any revisions or enhancements. Depending on the degree of revisions you make, this period may take between zero days to two weeks.

Step 4 - Begin Using Your OHATS. Once your revisions, if any, are made you can begin to track your history and accomplishments with your own OHATS. A generic Help Section will be available to show you or new reporters in your organization how to document, edit, view, and extract information from your OHATS. During 2002, additional help and support tools will be added to OHATS on the Tutor/Mentor Exchange, such as discussion group to share promising practices for program development and support for the tutor/mentor community. You may request periodic revisions to your OHATS based on how your needs change over time and with additional users.

3. Sample Formats of OHATS Forms and Reports

Please remember that these are only approximations of what your forms and reports will look like on the Internet, and will depend on your customization of OHATS.

Sample Form to Collect Reporter Descriptive and Log In Information

Name (Last, First)		
Best numbers to call	(First Choice)	(Second Choice)
Email		
Address	State	Zip Code
City		
Groups and organizations that you will be representing as an OHATS Reporter	Pull Down Menu (Allow multiple selections & "Other")	Describe "Other"
Password Confirm Password		

What part of the form is modified?

Sample Form to Document Actions, Events & Contributions

Reporter Information

Name Pull Down Menu (Includes "Anonymous" and "New Reporter")	Organization Representing Pull Down Menu (Includes "Anonymous" & "New Organization")
--	---

Item Description

When did this happen? Start Date End Date <i>He live date it</i> ☐ Check if date(s) are estimated. <i>occurred</i>	Is this item intended to: Pull Down Menu • Be permanent • Occur only once • Repeat, but with planned end date • Duration does not matter for this item
--	---

WHAT happened? [Please write this so that someone NOT familiar with your work can understand it. Avoid acronyms and abbreviations. Describe how this is important to the history, mission, outcomes or survival of the work of the organization.]

I Don't know if this is needed - I don't enter in important stuff or most negative stuff

How important is this to the organization?

NOT AT ALL			VERY MUCH		
0	0	0	0	0	0

Does this influence the organization mostly:

POSITIVELY			NEGATIVELY		
0	0	0	0	0	0

WHO helped make this happen?
(Leave blank if necessary.)
Example: Mike Soo, After-School Programs]

What group or organization is this most important to? |Pull Down Menu|
(Allow multiple selections & "Other" do describe new groups)

This is significant as: (Check All That Apply)

- ☐ A lesson
- ☐ History
- ☐ Outcome or accomplishment
- ☐ Critical event

This item: |Pull Down Menu|

- New (not happened before)
- Not new, but different in an important way
- Not new or different

Which goal does this most relate to?

(Check All That Apply)

A LIST OF YOUR ORGANIZATION GOALS OR OBJECTIVES GOES HERE

What is the intended purpose or result?

(Check All That Apply)

- ☐ Celebration/Recognition
- ☐ Community mobilization & collaboration
- ☐ Marketing/ Publicity
- ☐ Organizational practice change
- ☐ Planning strategies/actions
- ☐ Policy/ Legislative change
- ☐ Program creation/implementation
- ☐ Other: Please describe

TAG THIS ITEM for use in: (Check all that apply.)

- ☐ Advocacy/Policy development
- ☐ Media/Press release
- ☐ Grant/Funding proposal

- ☐ Newsletter / Professional publication
- ☐ Meeting or presentation
- ☐ Other: Please describe

Submit My Comments

Email My Comments to a Friend

Sample Data Entry Form for Service or Program Statistics of the Organization

Program A (name pull-down)	Month / Year
<i>Kios based on Success</i> <i>Conf Success</i>	
Numbers Served	
___	Number of workshops
___	Number of workshop participants
Service Costs	
___	Number of staff hours for this program
Referrals To	
___	Organizations/Program (include list of organizations and programs)
Referrals From	
___	Organizations/Program (include list of organizations and programs)
Results	
___	Number of new graduates
___	Number of graduates that enter college or employment
Recorder Comments (Please describe any peculiarities and items of importance for interpreting this information.)	

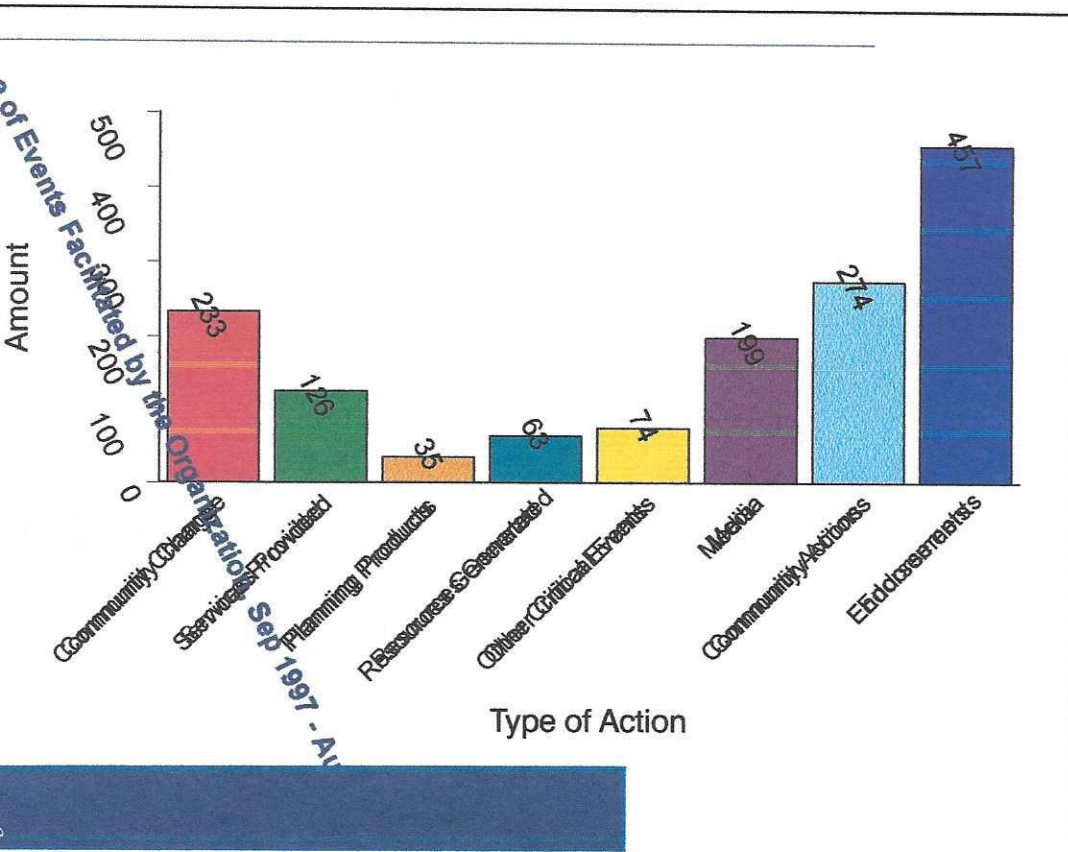
Sample View of Descriptions of Accomplishments in a Report (similar views can exist for different categories, such as items marked as "lessons," or "key historical events" for the organization)

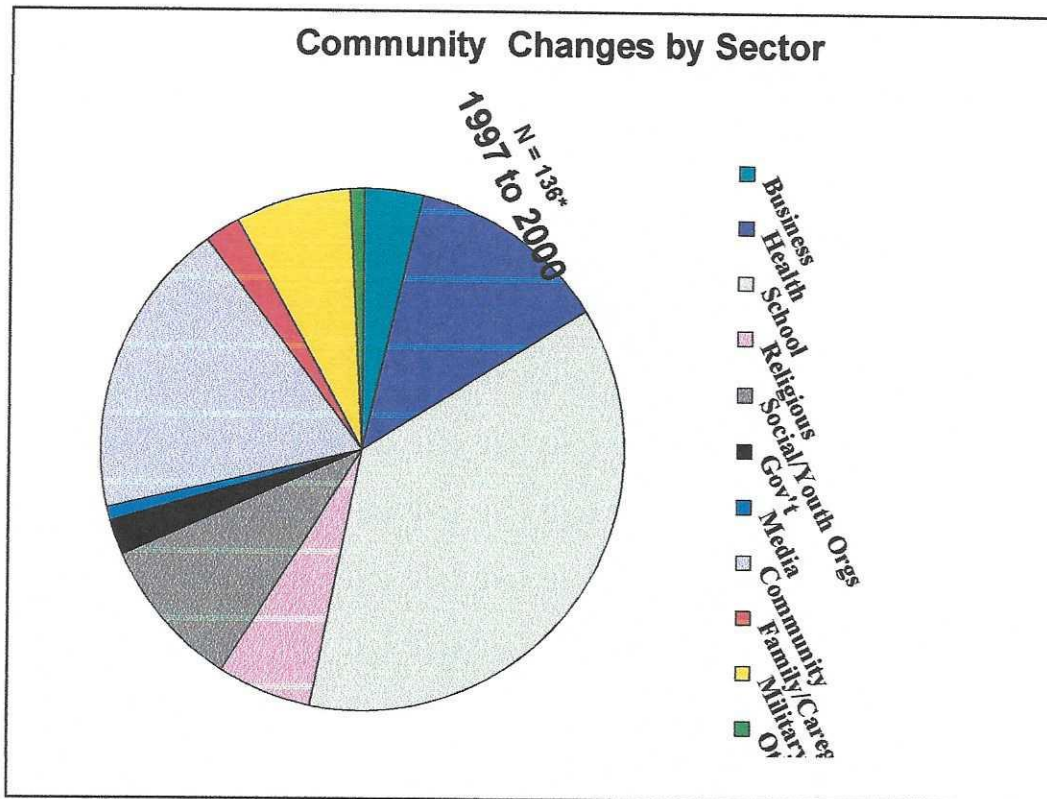
Date	Accomplishment or Contribution
02/16/01	Met with the CEO and Marketing Chief of First Gain Bank, and decided to collaborate on mutually beneficial work. This will likely include internships for our students and support for college scholarships.
05/10/01	Began a new Internet tutoring program through the website of Skills for Students Success based in Norfolk, South Carolina.
01/07/02	The regional Air Force Academy established a new policy to allow cadets paid time off to volunteer as tutors up to 4 days each month in our programs.

Sample View of a Table Showing the Number of Accomplishments and Contributions Across Organizational Goals
 (similar tables can exist for different categories, such as OHATS items across types of entry - lesson, accomplishment, historical item, or by types of geographic areas targeted by the organization)

Reporting Period 1/01 - 12/01	
Goal	Total Number
Increase the number of programs or services.	12
Establish new collaborations with corporate and philanthropic partners.	18
Help business, nonprofit, and civic organizations change their policies to facilitate volunteer mentoring.	26

Sample View of a Graphs Showing Categorization of Events Facilitated by the Organization
 (similar views can exist in different formats - bar, line and pie graphs - and for different categories, such as accomplishments across types of goals, or types of geographic areas targeted by the organization)





4. OHATS Development Requirements, Timeline and Costs

Development and Use Requirements

To create and use OHATS you will require:

- access to a computer that contains hardware and software to connect to the Internet (e.g., internal or external modem, dial-up or Internet connection software),
- a method of connecting to the Internet (e.g., an account to dial-up or otherwise connect to the Internet via 56k modem, DSL, T1-line, etc.), and
- an Internet browser (e.g., Microsoft Internet Explorer, Netscape, etc.).

While any Internet browser can be used, your OHATS experience will be easier and faster if your browser supports accepted web standards (please see <http://archive.webstandards.org/upgrade/>). If you are using a browser with a version not older than one year, your browser likely meets these standards.

Your OHATS data can be viewed and edited directly on the website without any additional software. Additional requirements depend on whether you wish to download, manipulate and print your OHATS data and reports outside of the Tutor/Mentor Exchange website. OHATS data can be provided to you formatted as a Microsoft Access table (version 1997 or 2000), in a Microsoft Excel file, or in some other common structured data file (e.g., comma or tab delimited). To view and use of your data outside of the Tutor/Mentor Exchange website, you would require software that can use these data formats.

Adobe Acrobat reader can be also be useful for viewing some web-based OHATS reports. (available at <http://www.adobe.com/products/acrobat/alternate.html>)

Development Timeline and Costs

The time and costs required to create an OHATS for your organizations depends largely on the amount of customization and support that you request. You can select various types and degrees of support for your OHATS ranging from the standard support to design and start using your OHATS up to monthly contact with our team to help you use your OHATS for grant searches and proposals, publicity and media events, organizational and program evaluation, and strategic planning for your organization. The descriptions on the following pages show approximate requirements for three situations common to OHATS clients. Your specific needs and costs may fall somewhere within what is described here, and can be negotiate with our OHATS Support Staff. Additional customization as with PDA use and non-web use of OHATS can be requested.

The aim of Tutor/Mentor Exchange is to make all of its tools and services easily accessible to any tutor/mentor organization or supporter. We realize that for some nonprofit organizations funding is limited and costs can prevent the use of supportive tools such as OHATS. Please feel free to contact us if you would like to use OHATS but feel the costs would prohibit you from doing so. We would be happy to find a way to help you.

Situation 1: Standard Customization and Support

Products & Services Provided

OHATS Parts

Web screens to edit, input, search, & report information for 2 OHATS parts:

- Reporter Description and Log In
- Documentation of Actions, Events & Contributions

Customization

Can change the wording and selection options of the following variables:

- Organizational Goal/Objective
- Result or Purpose of Item
- Tag Item for Use In ...

(see page 5 for examples)

Reports

Live text summaries of all OHATS information, with queries by:

- Date
- Type of Item (*history, accomplishment, lesson, critical event*)
- Goal or Objective Categories
- Result or Purpose Categories

Support

- Telephone contact to set up OHATS and up to 10 hours for the first month of use
- Unlimited email contact
- Unlimited web-based help and chat room support
- Telephone contact when you need help to download your OHATS data or wish to discontinue OHATS

Development Timeline

2 to 6 weeks:

- 1 - 2 weeks, Negotiate use and customization
- 1 - 2 week, customize and test prototype
- 0 - 2 weeks, revise and practice use

Costs

\$3,000	One-time development and set up fee
\$500	Annual support costs after the first year
\$200	Annual data housing and management fee (after the first year)

Additional telephone support available:

- Hourly: \$50/hour
- Monthly: \$200 up to 10 hours
- Annually: \$2,000 up to 10 hours/month

Situation 3: Premium Customization and Support

Products & Services Provided

OHATS Parts

Web screens to edit, input, search, & report information for all 5 OHATS parts:

- Reporter Description and Log In
- Documentation of Actions, Events & Contributions
- Documentation of Publicity and Media
- Documentation of Resources Generated
- Documentation of Service Statistics

Creation of additional data entry and management beyond the 5 OHATS parts.

Customization

Can change the wording and selection options of the following variables of these forms:

Documentation of Actions, Events & Contributions Form

- Organizational Goal/Objective
- Result or Purpose of Item
- Tag Item for Use In ...
- Customization of Sector, Strategy, Location, and Target Population variables

Documentation of Publicity and Media

- Organizational Goal/Objective
- Type of media or publicity
- Tag Item for Use In ...

Documentation of Resources Generated

- Names of Common and Target Funders or Donors

Documentation of Service Statistics

- Names of programs and services
- Names and format of outcomes
- Names of referring/referred sources

(see pages 5 - 6 for examples)

Additional customization of new data entry forms beyond the 5 OHATS parts.

Reports

Live text summaries of all OHATS information, with queries as noted for the different OHATS parts:

Documentation of Actions, Events & Contributions Form

- Date
- Type of Item (history, accomplishment, lesson, critical event)
- Goal or Objective Categories
- Result or Purpose Categories
- Sector, Strategy, Location, and Target Population

Documentation of Publicity and Media

- Date
- Type of media or publicity

Documentation of Resources Generated

- Date
- Type of Funders or Donors

Documentation of Service Statistics

- Date
- Type of programs or services
- Type of referring/referred sources

(see pages 6 - 8 for examples)

Additional report options and formats for existing OHATS parts and for new data entry forms beyond the 5 OHATS parts.

Statistical analysis of data over time and across categories to help your organization evaluate past and project future progress of organizational contributions, service provision, publicity, and funding.

Support

- Telephone contact to set up OHATS and up to 30 hours for the first month of use
- Up to 10 hours free telephone support each month to assist with data summary, sense-making, and application in reports, media and funding opportunities.
- Monthly review of your OHATS information to identify key support, funding and publicity opportunities by the OHATS Support Team
- Quarterly review, summary and analysis of OHATS events for evaluation purposes
- Unlimited email contact
- Unlimited web-based help and chat room support
- Telephone contact when you need help to download your OHATS data or wish to discontinue OHATS

Development Timeline

9 to 15 weeks:

- 4 - 6 weeks, Negotiate use and customization
- 3 - 6 week, customize and test prototype
- 2 - 3 weeks, revise and practice use

Costs

\$12,000 and up* One-time development and set up fee
\$4,000 and up* Annual support costs after the first year
\$200 Annual data housing and management fee (after the first year)

Additional telephone support available:

- Hourly: \$50/hour
- Monthly: \$200 up to 10 hours
- Annually: \$2,000 up to 10 hours/month

* Total costs will vary with the amount and type of new data screens created, and the type and amount of customized support requested.

5. Closing Comments

OHATS is a web application that uses relational database technology to help a group, organization or network of community organizations to record, observe, analyze and report contributions and key events that influence progress toward its mission and goals. OHATS simplifies the collection and organization of data to increase:

- a. The number of organization staff and stakeholders who document contributions toward organizational outcomes and objectives,
- b. The number and type of actions and accomplishments reported,
- c. The number of lessons that can be drawn from such intelligence, and
- d. The rate of exchange of such intelligence with people in and out of the organization.

We hope this brief presentation of OHATS has helped you to better understand how your organization can design and use its own customized OHATS. When used appropriately, OHATS can help your organization capture and share its evolution and contributions over time. Most social welfare and grassroots organizations often lack resources (time, money, skills) and stable staffing to create habits and use tools to regularly examine what they do in a way that leads to useful discovery and improvement. Often, lessons and contributions are archived in meeting notes, annual reports, and academic publications. In most community organizations intelligence and wisdom stay and die with individuals and organizations. This hurts not only individual organizations and their stakeholders, but also entire community efforts that are sustained through collaboration and exchange. The absence of useful tools to track and reflect on progress leads many community organizations and initiatives to repeat preventable problems, struggle to identify their needs, lessons and best practices, and to share them with peers, and be unable to demonstrate neither daily impact, nor cumulative impact over years of service. These problems weaken all community work, and contribute to the extinction of organizations and community improvement initiatives. OHATS is an attempt to prevent this loss of community wisdom, and to enhance and expand how community-based organizations positively impact the health and development of their community.

Please do not hesitate to contact us if we can answer any questions or if we can make it easier for you to begin using OHATS in your organization. We look forward to supporting your community improvement efforts.

Sincerely,
The OHATS Support Team